

OSF × ANDELA · INFORMATION YOU CAN TRUST

RAIA — Radio AI Africa

A civic radio station produced by AI agents, where every sentence that goes on air traces back to a named source you can check — and everything the station refused to air is published beside what it did.

5

languages on air

28

verified outlets

26

stories refused today

Track: Transparency & Accountability · with Stability & Social Cohesion, and Safety & Protection

THE PROBLEM

Civic information assumes a reader. Radio assumes nothing.

Reach

Dashboards, portals and PDFs assume a smartphone, data, literacy, and English. Radio reaches people while they work, in the language they think in, on the cheapest device in the house.

Trust

A station that invents a date, a figure or a hotline number does more damage than one that stays silent. Generative tools make broadcast cheap — and make being confidently wrong cheap too.

So the question was never “can a model write a bulletin?” It was: [what has to be true in the code before a machine is allowed to say something out loud?](#)

WHO IT IS FOR

Two users, one station

The listener

Someone who wants to know what an institution decided this week, what it means for them, and what they can do about it — in Hausa, Yoruba, Igbo, Pidgin or English. They press one button and drop into whatever is on air, the way you tune a dial.

The newsroom

A small civic team — one editor, no studio — who sets the day's programme on a calendar, reads what the agents wrote, edits a script, and presses Generate. Overnight the station builds the next day by itself.

WHAT IT DOES

From a feed to a voice, with a veto in the middle

```
sources → extract → cluster → verify → edit → script → continuity → translate  
→ diacritics → GATE → render (TTS) → measure → assemble → schedule → publish
```

Sixteen stages, each checkpointed and re-runnable. Bulletins air on a fixed clock from measured durations, so everyone listening in a language hears the same sentence at the same moment. Nothing slow happens while a listener waits: the day is rendered in advance.

THE IDEA THAT MAKES IT TRUSTWORTHY

Models do the language. Code does the facts.

In this system a language model **never**:

- resolves a contradiction between sources — deterministic rules do
- touches a timestamp — durations come from `ffprobe`, the schedule is arithmetic
- invents a number, a quote, a URL or a hotline — each is checked against its source
- overrides the safety gate — sensitive stories wait for a human, with no override flag

Models write and translate. Everything a listener could be harmed by is decided in code that can be read, tested, and pointed at.

When INEC moved the election, the station had to move with it

In February 2026 INEC fixed the presidential election for **20 February 2027**, then revised it to **16 January 2027**. The articles carrying the old date are still online, and a naive summariser will happily read them out.

RAIA's verifier is tested against **those real archived pages**: a settled fact beats an official source, which beats the later report. It must air January — and when the official source is removed from the test, the later report must still win.

For figures with no official source, the contradiction is marked unresolved and **neither number airs**.

PROOF 2 · WHAT IT REFUSED

A station that has thought about when not to broadcast

26

stories refused today

146

refusals logged

12

stories aired

90 were sensitive and need a human editor · **54** could not be verified · one stated a fact the sources did not support · one promised a segment that would not air.

Every refusal is published with its reason on the site, next to what did air.
Transparency about silence is the part most systems hide.

Numbers that are real, listeners who stay private

11 of 14 hotlines

Each number read on air was confirmed on the agency's own page, with the date it was checked. The three that failed are listed as not aired rather than guessed at.

No phone number is stored

Listeners reach the station on WhatsApp. Numbers exist only as a salted hash; the thread expires on a database TTL; a question airs only with consent, and only as a first name and a city.

The presenters are synthetic — and the station says so once an hour, in every language, on every page, with no way to switch it off.

TODAY'S OUTPUT

One laptop, one day of radio

65.7

minutes of audio

9

bulletins with audio

5

languages

28

outlets read

English, Hausa, Yoruba and Igbo bulletins rendered on an M1 laptop with open weights (YarnGPT2). Pidgin is written, translated and gated, and publishes as text until a voice model is routed in — one line of configuration.

RAIA's presenters are synthetic voices made by artificial intelligence. Every story names its sources - check them on the Sources page.

RAIA newsroom

[Schedule](#) [Messages](#) [Bulletins](#) [Sources](#) [What we refused](#) [Hotlines](#) [About](#) [On air ↗](#) [Sign out](#)

<

Monday, September 21

>

today

open ▾

Build the whole day

All days

running

Building the whole day · enrich [19:01:33] enrich: 8 airing stories, 1 with a verified action, 1 explainers

Stop

6 AM

Morning Drive
06:00 - 07:30

Nothing selected

What this makes possible

A station per language, not per budget

The marginal cost of another language is a voice model and a translation pass, not another newsroom. Hausa, Yoruba and Igbo listeners get the same verified civic reporting on the same day as English ones.

Built to be handed over

A community station can run this: set the clock, watch the calendar fill overnight, edit a script, press Generate. No studio, no presenters, no night shift.

Accountability you can hear

Election dates, budget figures, hotline numbers and “what you can do about it” reach people who will never open a ministry PDF — with every claim traceable to the outlet that reported it.

Honest about its limits

No native speaker has yet signed off the Hausa, Yoruba and Igbo audio; Pidgin has no voice; WhatsApp is not on a live number. All stated in the README, because a trust project that hides its gaps is arguing against itself.

RAIA — RADIO AI AFRICA

Models for language. Code for facts.

Everything it aired, and everything it refused, is published beside it — with the source, the timestamp, and the rule that decided.

Python · FastAPI · MongoDB · Next.js · YarnGPT2 · Claude · 43 tests, including the archived-pages case